

MAJOR LEAGUE LIFE BEGINS AT 29

Mason May Come to Aid Of Relief-Poor Phillies

Special to The Evening News

CLEARWATER, Fl. — Henry Mason is deemed the rookie pitcher most likely to provide the Phillies with some sorely needed relief help this season.

This 29-year-old right-hander, who once performed for the Kansas City Monarchs, was considered the most versatile hurler in the International League last season when he pitched the Buffalo Bisons to the pennant with a sparkling 12-3 record.

It didn't make any difference to Henry whether he started or relieved. He started five games, going the distance in four, winning three, including a pair of shutouts. He also answered 36 emergency summons.

And he didn't drop a decision after June 12th.

JIM COKER, the Philadelphia rookie receiver who was behind the plate for Buffalo last summer, said of Mason: "He was marvelous. Everytime the ball club was in a jam, Mason would come in from the bullpen and get us out of it. He has the kind of curve ball that hitters despise — it's one of those off-the-table things."

Mason also happens to be

the class clown, a fountain of good humor for the Phillies during their training stay at Jack Russell Stadium here. Robin Roberts makes it a

practice to play "pepper" every chance he gets with the rookie and says, "I never had so much fun in my life."

THE OTHER day Mason panicked the players when he asked Coach Andy Cohen if the squad were to be split into A and B units during the exhibition season.

Cohen replied: "No, I don't think so. It will be the Cohens and the Carter's (another Phillies coach). Would you like to play for the Cohens?"

Mason hesitated before coming up with: "Nosiree, the only squad ah'm interested in playing on is Mr. Eddie Sawyer's squad."

CHANCES ARE he'll make it too. The Phillies are wide open for pitchers with Mason's obvious ability. Mason intends to take advantage of the situation.

"I know I can make this ball club," the confident pitcher put it. "But there ain't no use talking about it. The only thing to do is get out there and do it."

The Phillies are rooting for him. They sort of like the idea of having Henry around.

All-Stars



"Is it all right if I jump more than one hurdle at a time?"

CALENDAR

THURSDAY, MARCH 10
VARSITY BASKETBALL
Bishop McDevitt vs. Westmoreland
(Bloomsburg College Invitational)
FRIDAY, MARCH 11
VARSITY BASKETBALL
East Pennsboro vs. Faculty
GIRLS BASKETBALL
East Pennsboro vs. Alumnae
VARSITY WRESTLING
Southeastern Regional Tournament at
Manheim Central
SATURDAY, MARCH 12
PIAA Swimming Championships at Buck-nell